

Token sheet — plan for approval

For the master–detail layout with a pinned critical band, chosen in Pass A. Nothing in this document is a rendered screen — it is the set of colour, type, spacing and motion decisions Pass C will render into the five high-fidelity frames, held here for approval first.

DARK, NOT BLACK Three elevation levels, floor lifted off true black for a dim room and a 12-hour shift	COLOUR = PRIORITY, ONLY Saturation is reserved for meaning. Chrome, borders and structure stay neutral	NEVER COLOUR ALONE Every priority pairs a colour with an icon, a label and a border weight	DENSITY OVER COMFORT ~12 queue rows visible at 1440×900 with no scrolling
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STATUS

Plan for approval. Contrast ratios are stated against the ground surface; the 3px radius ceiling is the standing argument.

This subject already has a visual language — motorway signage, variable message signs, lane-control gantries, incident-log typography, camera OSD overlays. Three defaults were rejected on sight; four moves were taken from the reference set instead.



REJECTED

Warm cream + serif + terracotta

Reads editorial and slow — a magazine, not a monitoring instrument.



REJECTED

Near-black + acid-green accent

Acid green would be the loudest hue on screen with no meaning attached — it competes with the one colour that must win: critical.



REJECTED

Hairline broadsheet grid

A broadsheet is read start to finish. This screen is scanned in the same fixed order for twelve hours — it needs zones, not columns.

TAKEN FROM THE REFERENCE SET

VARIABLE MESSAGE SIGN

Saturation is the alert, not the decoration. Priority owns colour; the rest of the interface stays deliberately quiet.

LANE-CONTROL GANTRY ROUNDEL

A 3px radius ceiling. Chips and buttons get a small corner; panels stay square — an instrument bezel, not an app bubble.

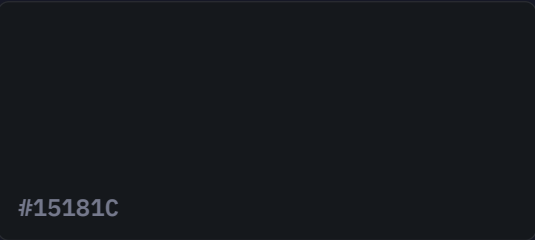
CAMERA OSD TIMECODE

Every live number sets in tabular mono, so a counter that ticks never shifts the pixels around it.

INCIDENT-LOG LEDGER

Dense hairline rows, not card padding. Twelve rows fit because nothing is decorated for its own sake.

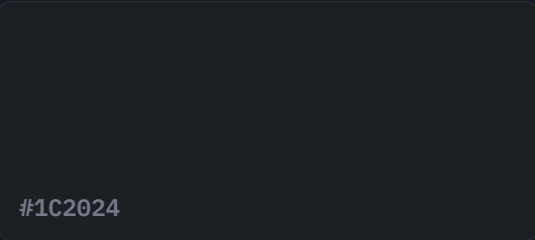
Why the floor sits above true black. A dim room adapts the eye's baseline down, so #000 next to white text and a critical-red chip creates simultaneous-contrast halation that gets worse across a 12-hour shift. The ground is lifted to roughly 9% luminance — dark enough that camera snapshots keep their own contrast, high enough that the eye is not fighting the interface itself by hour ten.



Surface 0 · ground

App background. Everything else sits on this.

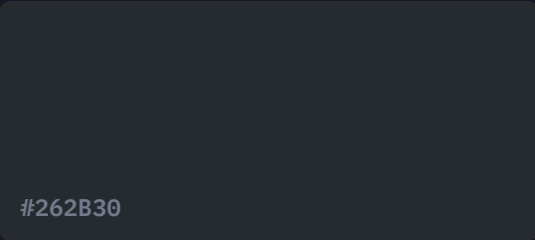
~9% luminance floor



Surface 1 · panel

Queue rows, side panels, the detail pane.

1.09× vs ground



Surface 2 · raised

Banner, modal, popover — anything temporarily on top.

1.25× vs ground



Text primary #E8EAED

14.77 : 1 against ground

Values that drive the decision — what, where, the facts.



Text secondary #9AA1AB

6.83 : 1 against ground

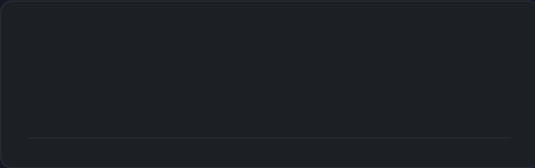
Labels and metadata — field names, captions.



Text tertiary #676E77

3.45 : 1 against ground

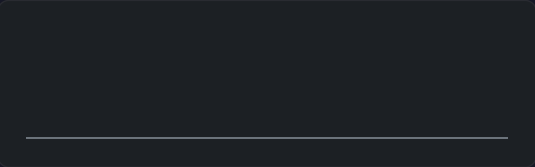
Large or tabular only — disabled state, timestamps of record.



Border, hairline #23272B

Decorative, no contrast floor

Row and rule dividers. Separation only — not a contrast-bearing boundary.



Border, component #6B737B

3.4–3.7 : 1 against panel / ground

Inputs, focus base, boundaries between major regions — held to the 3:1 UI floor.

CRITICAL Immediate hazard in a live lane or against traffic — wrong-way driver, person on the carriageway, fire.	MM 42.3 · T+00:07 #FF4433 · 5.2 : 1 border 4px · triangle
HIGH Hazard building or unconfirmed but severe — stopped vehicle in a live lane, heavy smoke.	MM 38.9 · T+01:42 #FFA426 · 8.98 : 1 border 3px · diamond
MEDIUM Hazard contained — hard-shoulder stop, debris clear of live lanes, developing congestion.	MM 51.0 · T+04:15 #E4C230 · 10.22 : 1 border 2px · circle
LOW Informational — resolved and logging, routine congestion, low-confidence detection awaiting confirmation.	MM 29.6 · T+11:30 #5B8DEF · 5.51 : 1 border 1px · square

Shape is a fifth cue on top of colour, icon, label and border weight — triangle, diamond, circle, square borrow directly from sign taxonomy (danger / warning / caution / info). The final glyph inside each shape is a Phosphor icon, chosen at high fidelity.

System state — live / reconnecting / offline

LIVE #5ba98c · 6.36 : 1 Feed connected, events processing normally. Steady, no motion.	RECONNECTING #b98a4a · 5.76 : 1 Dropped and retrying. Pulses — the only status dot allowed to move.	OFFLINE #9b5c5c · 3.46 : 1 Feed down. Static, paired with a frozen timestamp of last known state.
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Deliberately lower-chroma than the priority ramp above — a glance must never confuse “connection degraded” with “high priority.” Compare the amber here against High's amber above.

Public Sans

UI and body face. Public Sans descends from Interstate — the actual US highway-signage letterform — so its DNA is already a road typeface tuned for legibility at speed and at small sizes, not a marketing display face pressed into service. Set at medium weight throughout; this system never bolds past 600.

0123456789

Tabular numeric face — timestamps, camera IDs, mile markers, confidence, live age counters. IBM Plex Mono was built for technical instrumentation, carries true tabular-lining figures, and reads like the OSD burned into a camera feed rather than a coder's terminal font.

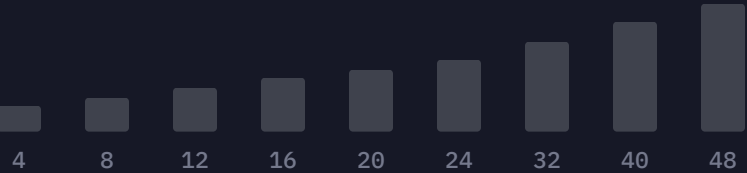
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	11 / 500 / 16	Dense micro-metadata — secondary line in a queue row
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	12 / 500 / 16	Kicker labels, section eyebrows
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	13 / 500 / 18	Captions, queue row secondary line
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	14 / 500 / 20	UI default — buttons, inputs, queue row primary line
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	16 / 500 / 22	Detail-pane body copy
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	18 / 600 / 24	Incident title, subsection headings
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	20 / 600 / 26	Panel headings — queue header, detail header
Camera 14 — lane 2 of 3	24 / 600 / 30	Dialog title — the only heading this large
MM 42.3 · 00:14:07	11 / 500	Mile markers, camera IDs in dense rows
MM 42.3 · 00:14:07	12 / 500	Timestamps, confidence %, latency
MM 42.3 · 00:14:07	14 / 500	Live age counters — the number operators track most
MM 42.3 · 00:14:07	16 / 600	Hero timestamp / large counter in the detail pane

T+00:14:07

T+00:14:08

Tabular-lining figures — every digit shares one advance width, so a counter that ticks once a second never reflows the characters beside it.

Spacing and radii

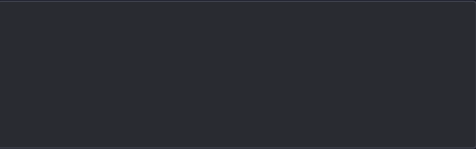


Every gap, padding and offset in the system is a multiple of 4.
Nothing lands off-grid, so dense rows stay optically even at 40px.



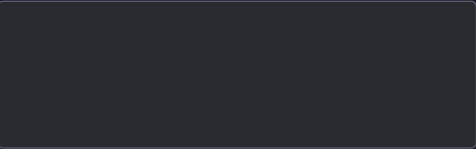
0px — panels, rows, cells

Flush rectangles. Reads as an instrument bezel, not a card.



2px — buttons, inputs

Just enough to read as a control, not a panel.



3px — priority chips, max

The ceiling. A chip is a tag, small enough to earn the corner.



12px — rejected

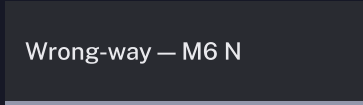
Reads soft and consumer-grade. An instrument doesn't need a hug.

Motion



Row insertion

180ms · cubic-bezier(.2,.7,.3,1). Slides down from the pinned band and fades in — pushed, never jumped.



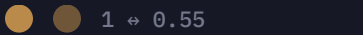
Banner entry

220ms · cubic-bezier(.16,.8,.24,1). Expands height from 0 and pushes content down — never overlays what was being read.



State transition

120ms · linear. Colour and label crossfade only — zero layout change, so the row never moves under the cursor.



Reconnecting pulse

1.6s loop · ease-in-out, opacity 1↔0.55. Runs only while degraded and stops the instant the state changes.

Reduced motion. Every duration above collapses to 0–100ms and drops its transform in favour of a plain opacity swap; anything that loops (only the reconnecting pulse does) stops looping and becomes a static state plus its label. No token here relies on motion to carry information that colour, icon and text don't already carry.